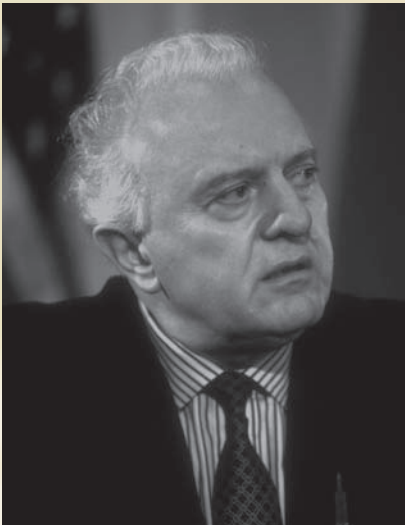




Eduard Shevardnadze

The last foreign minister of the USSR and president of Georgia 1995–2003, Shevardnadze forged his reputation fighting corruption, yet was forced out in the Rose Revolution for vote-rigging.

1990 Georgia declares sovereignty and secedes from the USSR.

1991 Georgia declares independence. Zviad Gamsakhurdia elected president.

1992 Gamsakhurdia flees Tbilisi. Shevardnadze chair of State Council.

1992–93 Fighting breaks out in Abkhazia between government troops and separatists. Ten thousand are killed.

1994 Ceasefire is established between government and Abkhaz separatists.

1995 Shevardnadze survives assassination attempt, elected president.

1999 Opening of pipeline from Caspian Sea to Black Sea.

2000 Shevardnadze is reelected. The withdrawal of Russian troops begins.

2003 In the so-called Rose Revolution, Shevardnadze is peacefully removed from office amid accusations of corruption.

2004 Mikhail Saakashvili is president after new elections. Leader of the autonomous region of Ajaria, Aslan Abashidze, rebels. He backs down after a stand-off and is forced into exile.

2005 Plans to grant autonomy to South Ossetia and Abkhazia within the Georgian state are announced.

2006 South Ossetians vote in favor of independence from Georgia.

2008 Russia intervenes in Georgia, claiming it is protecting the rights of South Ossetia. Its army occupies South Ossetia and parts of Georgia itself, and advances close to Tbilisi. President Medvedev withdraws troops from Georgia, but leaves them in South Ossetia.

«90–91 Frontiers of Power

Armenia



A former Soviet republic that suffered centuries of domination, often brutal, by neighboring states.

500s–400s BCE The Armenians are conquered by Persia and then by Alexander the Great.

1st century BCE Under Tigranes II, Armenia becomes a powerful state, establishing an empire for itself.

69 BCE Roman general Lucullus invades Armenia, which is thereafter disputed between Rome and the Parthian (later Sassanian) Persian empire.

301 CE Armenia converts to Christianity, the first sovereign nation to do so.

628 CE Becomes province of Byzantium.

885 CE Armenia regains independence, which it maintains until conquered by the Seljuk Turks in the 11th century.

1639 Partition of Armenia as the west becomes part of Turkey and the east is incorporated into the Persian Empire.

1828 Eastern Armenia part of the Russian Empire after the Russo-Persian war.

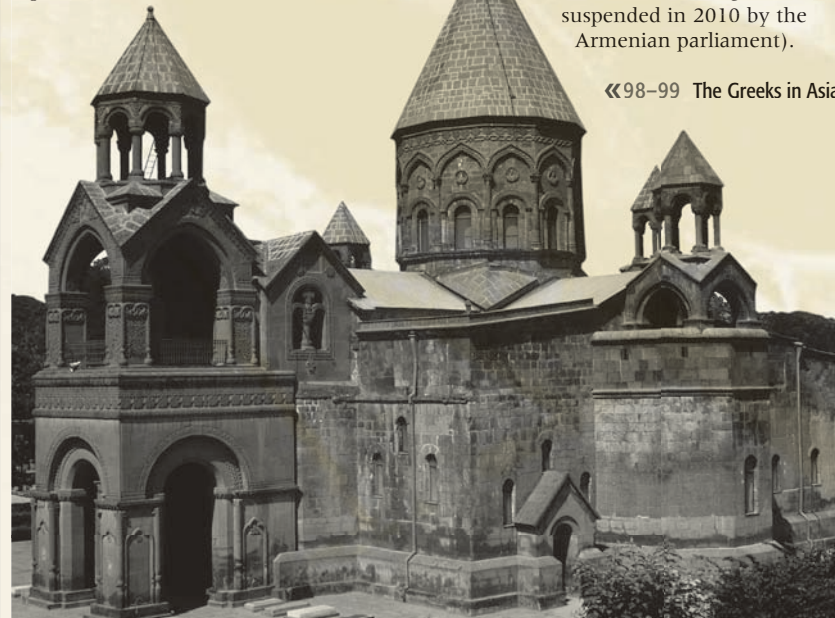
1877–78 Massacre of Armenians during Russo-Turkish war.

1894–96 Some 200,000 people in Turkish Armenia massacred by the Turks.

1915 Ottomans exile 1.75 million Turkish Armenians, and kill at least half of them.

1916 Czarist Russia conquers Armenia.

1918 Armenia becomes an independent republic.



First Christian state

Two years after Armenia became the first state to adopt Christianity as its official religion in 301 CE, Saint Gregory the Illuminator founded this cathedral at Echmiadzin, Armenia's holiest city. Gregory also founded the Armenian Apostolic Church.

1920 Invaded by Turkey and Russia. Socialist republic is declared.

1922 Becomes a Soviet republic.

1980s Encouraged by the USSR's policy of glasnost, demonstrations in Yerevan become more and more frequent.

1988 An earthquake in northern Armenia kills 25,000. The Medzamor nuclear power plant is declared unsafe and closed. Armenian population of Nagorno-Karabakh vote to secede from Azerbaijan, leading to civil conflict.

1990 Elections are won by Armenian nationalists. Independence is declared.

1991 Armenia joins the Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS) with Levon Ter Petrossian elected president.

1992 Armenia admitted to the UN.

1995 Medzamor nuclear plant reopens owing to an energy crisis, despite warnings that it is still unsafe.

1994 The region of Nagorno-Karabakh in Azerbaijan proclaims itself a republic with ethnic Armenian forces in control.

1998 Ter Petrossian resigns over opposition to his desire to compromise over Nagorno-Karabakh. Nationalist Robert Kocharyan replaces him.

1999 Gunmen open fire in the Armenian parliament, killing the prime minister, the speaker, and six others.

2007 A bill allowing dual citizenship is passed, paving the way for the naturalization of an estimated 8 million people in Armenia's diaspora.

2009 Turkey and Armenia agree to normalize relations (but ratification of the agreement is suspended in 2010 by the Armenian parliament).

«98–99 The Greeks in Asia

Azerbaijan



The first Soviet republic to declare independence, oil reserves are the key to its future prosperity.

300s CE The area which is now Azerbaijan falls under the domination of the Persian Sassanian dynasty.

641 Muslims conquer the region.

1000s Seljuk Turks dominate the region until overrun by the Mongols under Genghis Khan in the 13th century, and Tamerlane in the 14th century.

1728 Treaty of Constantinople affirms Ottoman control over the region after 300 years of rivalry between Turkey and Persia.

1828 The Treaty of Turkmenchai divides the region along the Araks River between Persia (to the south) and Russia.

1918 UK forces help install an independent, nationalist government in Azerbaijan. Azerbaijan declares neutrality in the Russian Civil War.

1920 Red Army invades.

1922 Azerbaijan is incorporated in Transcaucasian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic (TSFSR).

1930 Forced collectivization of agriculture.

1936 TSFSR is disbanded and Azerbaijan becomes a full union republic (ASSR).

1945 Attempted annexation of Azeri region of Iran.

1990 Nagorno-Karabakh attempts secession. Soviet troops move in.

1991 Azerbaijan gains independence.

1993 Heydar Aliyev is elected president.

1994 Ceasefire in war with Armenia over Nagorno-Karabakh.

1995 A rebellion by the special police led by Rovshan Jovadov is crushed.

2001 Azerbaijan becomes a full member of the Council of Europe.

2002 Construction work begins on an oil pipeline from Azerbaijan to Turkey.

2003 Heydar Aliyev dies.

2004 Ilham Aliyev, son of Heydar, is elected president.

2005 Ruling New Azerbaijan Party wins elections amid allegations of fraud.

2008 Ilhan Aliyev wins a second term in elections boycotted by the opposition.

«98–99 The Greeks in Asia
«246–47 The Ottoman Empire